

TidyTuesday Week 35

Pranay Gundam

Thursday 27th August, 2026

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1 Weekly Summary

AI-Generated Content

The summary below was written by Claude (Anthropic) from that week's regression outputs and series descriptions. It has not been reviewed or fact-checked by a human, and should be read as an automated, informal recap – not analysis.

Welcome back to the weekly ritual where we shove two economic series that have never met into a blender and pretend the resulting smoothie means something. As always, the machine picks these pairings at random, no theory or dignity involved, and any correlation you see should be treated with roughly the same scientific respect you'd give a fortune cookie. With that ceremonial disclaimer out of the way, let's tour the wreckage.

Monday kicked things off with Other Business Receivables Owned by Finance Companies staring longingly at a Total Nonfarm Diffusion Index, and the two of them could barely be bothered to acknowledge each other. An R-squared of 0.006 – yes, that's roughly six-tenths of one percent of anything explained – and a p-value loitering around 0.10 in both the raw and detrended versions. The rare case where nothing changes when you remove the trend, purely because there was no relationship to remove in the first place. Truly a nothingburger, served cold. Tuesday somehow topped it: Auto Production Seasonal Factors versus Reissue Patents Originating in Romania produced a big beautiful pile of NaNs, the statistical equivalent of the regression getting up and walking out of the room. I don't blame it. Pairing a monthly seasonal-adjustment fudge factor with annual Romanian patent reissues is exactly the kind of matchup this project was built to humiliate, and it responded by refusing to compute at all.

Wednesday is where it gets mildly interesting, if you squint. The (discontinued, RIP) San Francisco Tech Pulse index went up against the number of women aged 25-64 with master's degrees in the labor force, and the raw regression coughed up a p-value with seven zeros after the decimal – extremely "significant" looking. Normally this is the exact moment I put on my dunking shoes and wait for the detrended version to expose it as two lines that both drifted upward over time holding hands for no reason. Except... it didn't fully collapse. Detrending actually nudged the R-squared up from 0.10 to 0.14 and the relationship stayed rock-solidly significant. So credit where it's due: something wiggles together here even after stripping the shared drift. Do I have a mechanism connecting tech-sector vibes to the credentialing of professional women? No. Am I going to invent one? Also no. But it's a genuinely less-fake result than usual, which around here counts as a national holiday.

Then Thursday came in swinging with the raw regression of the week: the Employment Cost Index for manufacturing professionals versus the Consumer Price Index for Food at Home, posting a jaw-dropping R-squared of 0.95. Ninety-five percent! Break out the champagne, we've discovered that... wait for it... two price-and-cost indexes both went up over the decades. Shocking. This is the textbook trend mirage, and sure enough, once you detrend, the R-squared face-plants

down to 0.43. Now, that's not nothing – it does stay significant, so there's some real co-movement in the wiggles once you subtract the "everything gets more expensive over time" backdrop – but that 0.95 was doing a lot of theatrical heavy lifting, and I refuse to let it take a bow. In summary: two total whiffs, one suspicious survivor, and one drama queen that lost half its glory the second we made it work for a living. Same time next week, same complete absence of causal claims.

2 Date: 2026-08-24

Series ID: DTBOOXDFBANM

This series is titled Other Business Receivables Owned by Finance Companies, Flow and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Millions of Dollars, Monthly Rate and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1980-07-01 and the observation end date is 2026-05-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

Series ID: SMS000000000000000022

This series is titled Diffusion Indexes, 3-Month Span: Total Nonfarm and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1991-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 17.

2.1 Raw Regression

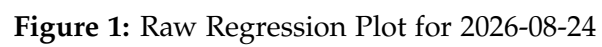
Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SMS000000000000000022	R-squared:	0.007			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.004			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	2.780			
Date:	Mon, 24 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0962			
Time:	12:21:23	Log-Likelihood:	-1980.1			
No. Observations:	425	AIC:	3964.			
Df Residuals:	423	BIC:	3972.			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	76.2916	1.244	61.331	0.000	73.847	78.737
value_fred_DTBOOXDFBANM	0.0009	0.001	1.667	0.096	-0.000	0.002
Omnibus:	115.402	Durbin-Watson:	0.217			
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	214.702			
Skew:	-1.569	Prob(JB):	2.39e-47			
Kurtosis:	4.511	Cond. No.	2.40e+03			

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.4e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.



2.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_SMS00000000000000022_detrended	R-squared:	0.006
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.004
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	2.758
Date:	Mon, 24 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	0.0975
Time:	12:21:24	Log-Likelihood:	-1980.1
No. Observations:	425	AIC:	3964.
Df Residuals:	423	BIC:	3972.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	4.49e-14	1.242	3.62e-14	1.000	-2.441	2.441
value_fred_DTBOOXDFBANM_detrended	0.0009	0.001	1.661	0.098	-0.000	0.002

Omnibus:	115.439	Durbin-Watson:	0.217
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	214.833
Skew:	-1.569	Prob(JB):	2.24e-47
Kurtosis:	4.513	Cond. No.	2.39e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.39e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

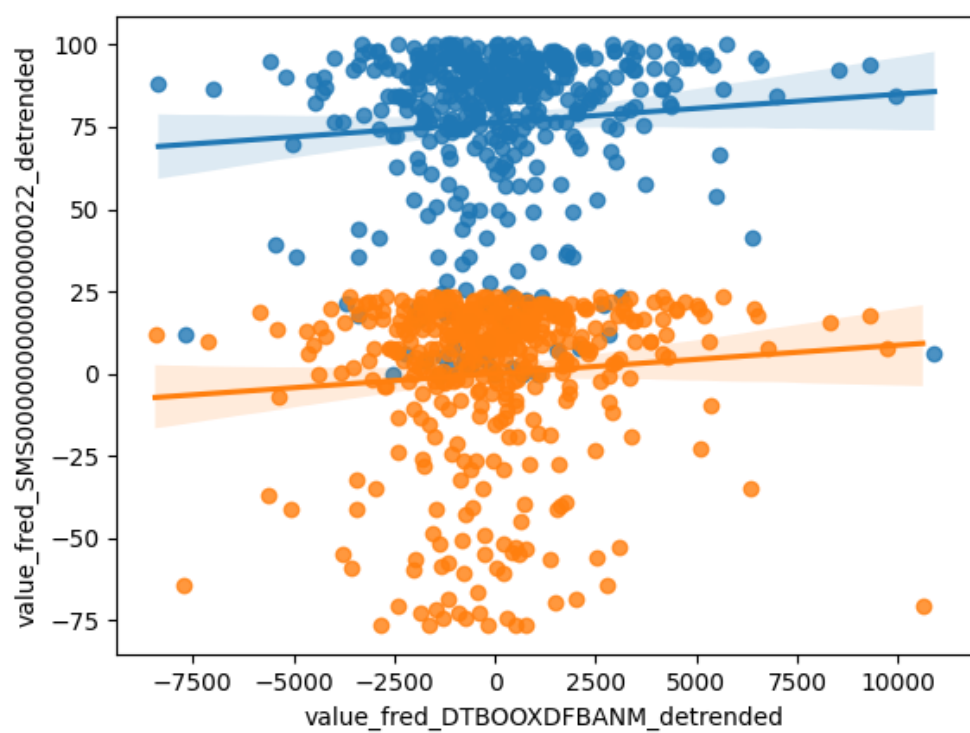


Figure 2: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-24

3 Date: 2026-08-25

Series ID: G17MVSFAUTOS

This series is titled Regular Seasonal Factors: Auto Production and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Seasonal Factor and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1996-01-01 and the observation end date is 2027-09-01. The popularity of this series is 4.

Series ID: PATENT4NROREISSUE

This series is titled U.S. Granted Patents: Reissue Patents Originating in Romania and has a frequency of Annual. The units are Number and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1993-01-01 and the observation end date is 2020-01-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

3.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PATENT4NROREISSUE	R-squared:	nan
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	nan
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	nan
Date:	Tue, 25 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	nan
Time:	12:22:02	Log-Likelihood:	inf
No. Observations:	25	AIC:	-inf
Df Residuals:	23	BIC:	-inf
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	0	0	nan	nan	0	0
value_fred_G17MVSFAUTOS	0	0	nan	nan	0	0

Omnibus:	nan	Durbin-Watson:	nan
Prob(Omnibus):	nan	Jarque-Bera (JB):	nan
Skew:	nan	Prob(JB):	nan
Kurtosis:	nan	Cond. No.	2.33e+03

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

[2] The condition number is large, 2.33e+03. This might indicate that there are strong multicollinearity or other numerical problems.

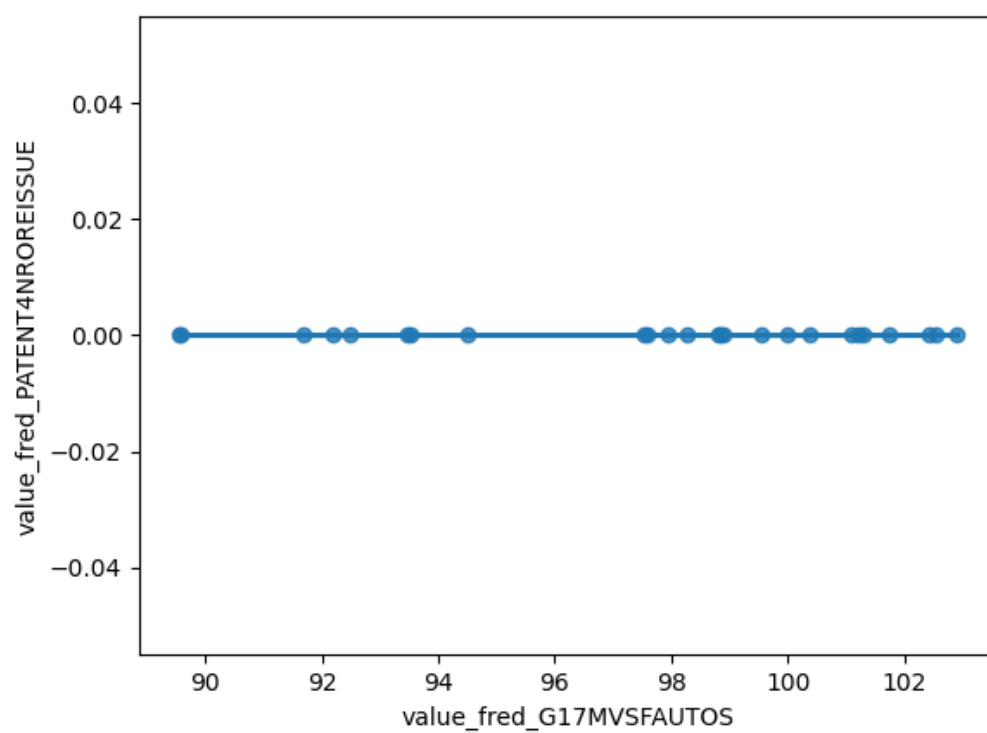


Figure 3: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-25

3.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_PATENT4NRROREISSUE_detrended	R-squared:	nan
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	nan
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	nan
Date:	Tue, 25 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	nan
Time:	12:22:03	Log-Likelihood:	inf
No. Observations:	25	AIC:	-inf
Df Residuals:	23	BIC:	-inf
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	0	0	nan	nan	0	0
value_fred_G17MVSFAUTOS_detrended	0	0	nan	nan	0	0

Omnibus:	nan	Durbin-Watson:	nan
Prob(Omnibus):	nan	Jarque-Bera (JB):	nan
Skew:	nan	Prob(JB):	nan
Kurtosis:	nan	Cond. No.	3.92

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

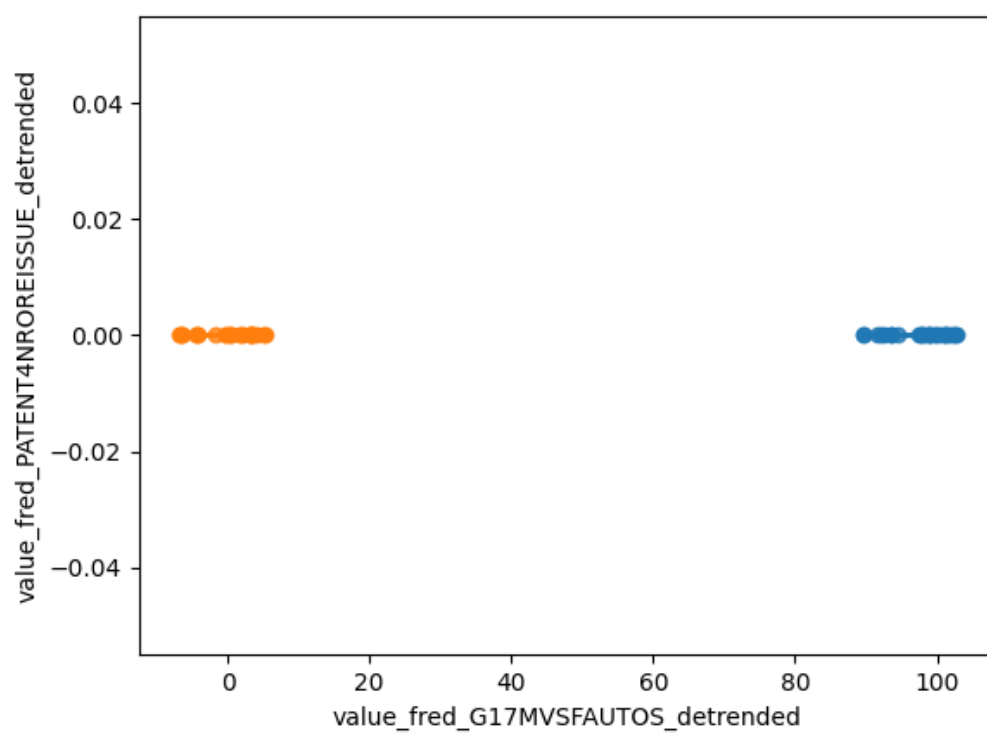


Figure 4: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-25

4 Date: 2026-08-26

Series ID: SFTPINDM114SFRBSF

This series is titled San Francisco Tech Pulse (DISCONTINUED) and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index Jan 2000=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1971-04-01 and the observation end date is 2020-03-01. The popularity of this series is 9.

Series ID: CGMDLW2564

This series is titled Civilian Labor Force - College Graduates - Master's Degree, 25 to 64 years, Women and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Thousands of Persons and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2000-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

4.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CGMDLW2564	R-squared:	0.100
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.096
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	26.65
Date:	Wed, 26 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	5.10e-07
Time:	12:24:10	Log-Likelihood:	-2072.8
No. Observations:	243	AIC:	4150.
Df Residuals:	241	BIC:	4157.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	3082.1539	563.746	5.467	0.000	1971.655	4192.653
value_fred_SFTPINDM114SFRBSF	34.1431	6.614	5.162	0.000	21.115	47.172

Omnibus:	8.541	Durbin-Watson:	0.010
Prob(Omnibus):	0.014	Jarque-Bera (JB):	8.940
Skew:	-0.458	Prob(JB):	0.0114
Kurtosis:	2.789	Cond. No.	609.

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

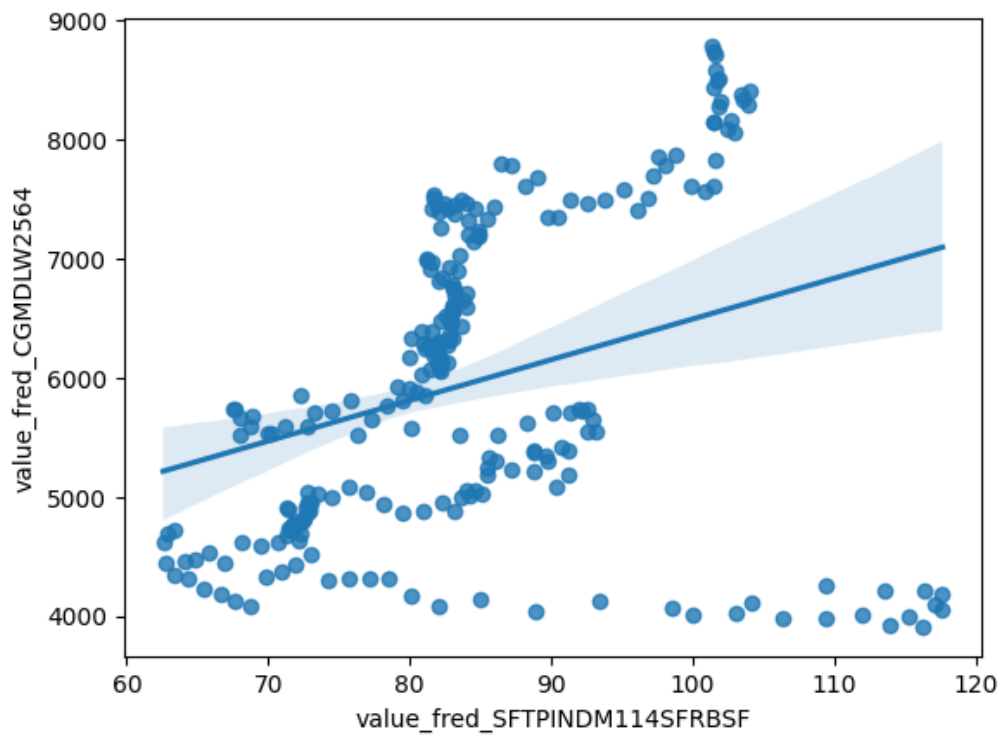


Figure 5: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-26

4.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CGMDLW2564_detrended	R-squared:	0.136
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.132
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	37.94
Date:	Wed, 26 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	3.04e-09
Time:	12:24:10	Log-Likelihood:	-1604.9
No. Observations:	243	AIC:	3214.
Df Residuals:	241	BIC:	3221.
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-3.482e-11	11.508	-3.03e-12	1.000	-22.668	22.668
value_fred_SFTPINDM114SFRBSF_detrended	6.1602	1.000	6.159	0.000	4.190	8.130

Omnibus:	7.909	Durbin-Watson:	0.417
Prob(Omnibus):	0.019	Jarque-Bera (JB):	9.938
Skew:	0.259	Prob(JB):	0.00695
Kurtosis:	3.845	Cond. No.	11.5

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

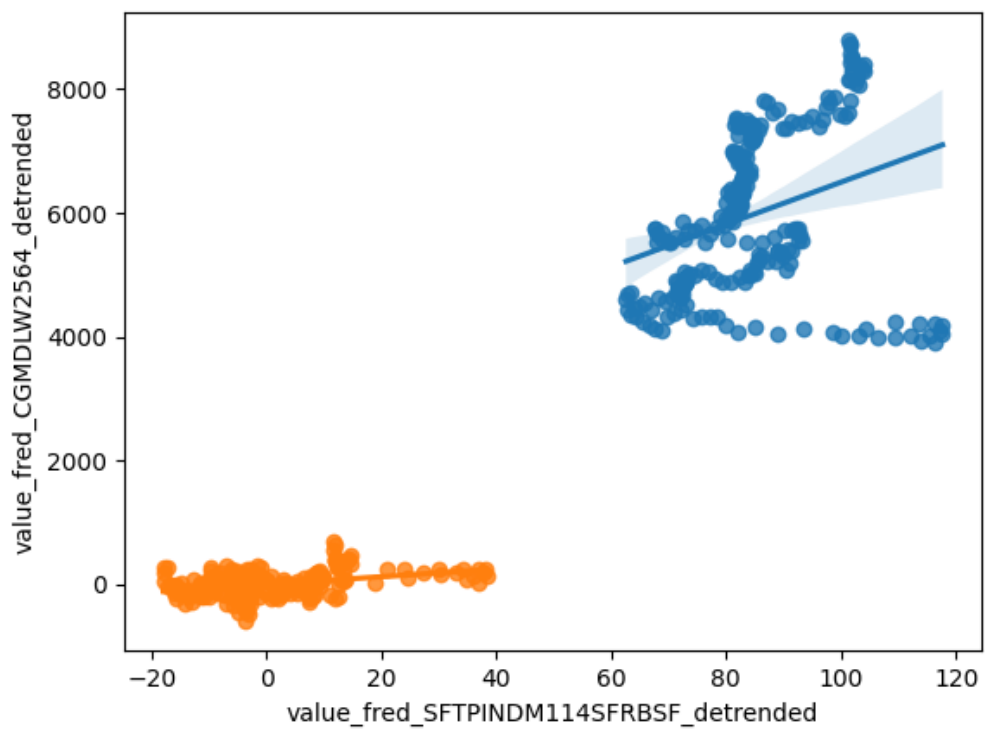


Figure 6: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-26

5 Date: 2026-08-27

Series ID: CIU2013000100000I

This series is titled Employment Cost Index: Total compensation for Private industry workers in Manufacturing; management, professional, and related occupations and has a frequency of Quarterly. The units are Index Dec 2005=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Not Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 2001-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-04-01. The popularity of this series is 3.

Series ID: CWSR0000SAF11

This series is titled Consumer Price Index for All Urban Wage Earners and Clerical Workers: Food at Home in U.S. City Average and has a frequency of Monthly. The units are Index 1982-1984=100 and the seasonal adjustment is Seasonally Adjusted. The observation start date is 1952-01-01 and the observation end date is 2026-07-01. The popularity of this series is 1.

5.1 Raw Regression

Regresses the two series against each other directly. A significant result here can come just as easily from both series sharing a long-run trend as from any real relationship.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CWSR0000SAF11	R-squared:	0.952			
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.951			
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	1958.			
Date:	Thu, 27 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	4.92e-67			
Time:	21:22:56	Log-Likelihood:	-363.32			
No. Observations:	101	AIC:	730.6			
Df Residuals:	99	BIC:	735.9			
Df Model:	1					
Covariance Type:	nonrobust					
	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	10.1646	5.080	2.001	0.048	0.085	20.245
value_fred_CIU2013000100000I	1.8620	0.042	44.250	0.000	1.779	1.946
	Omnibus:	5.948	Durbin-Watson:	0.072		
	Prob(Omnibus):	0.051	Jarque-Bera (JB):	5.044		
	Skew:	-0.455	Prob(JB):	0.0803		
	Kurtosis:	2.391	Cond. No.	691.		

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

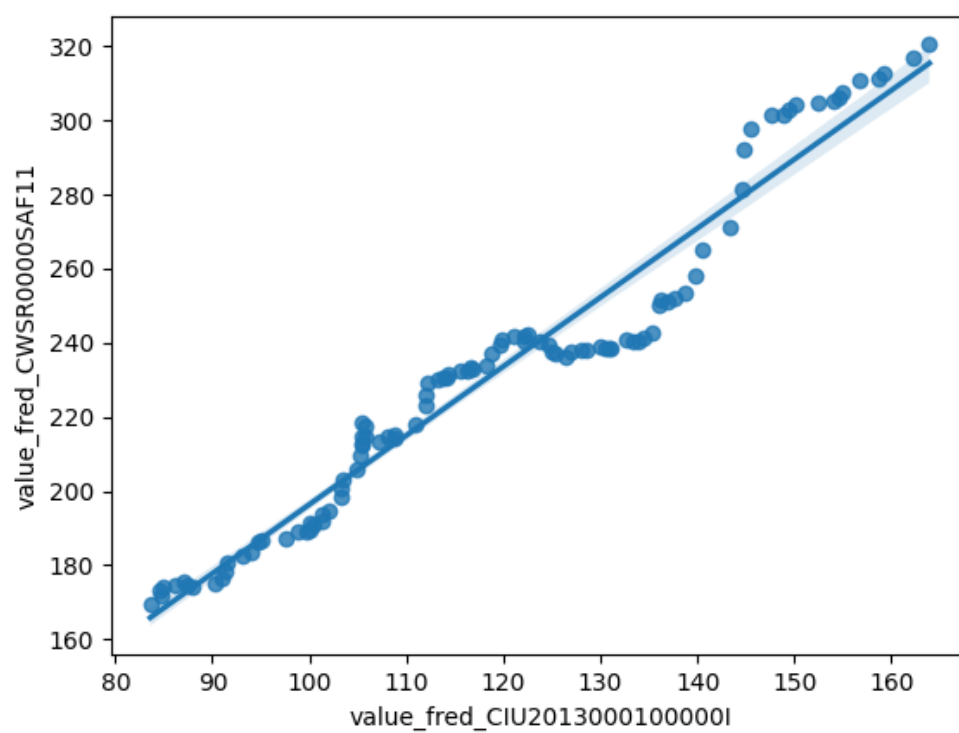


Figure 7: Raw Regression Plot for 2026-08-27

5.2 Detrended Regression

Regresses the residuals of each series after removing its own linear time trend, so a shared trend can no longer drive the result on its own. A relationship that stays significant here is better evidence of a genuine link between the two series.

Dep. Variable:	value_fred_CWSR0000SAF11_detrended	R-squared:	0.434
Model:	OLS	Adj. R-squared:	0.428
Method:	Least Squares	F-statistic:	75.78
Date:	Thu, 27 Aug 2026	Prob (F-statistic):	7.23e-14
Time:	21:22:57	Log-Likelihood:	-358.47
No. Observations:	101	AIC:	720.9
Df Residuals:	99	BIC:	726.2
Df Model:	1		
Covariance Type:	nonrobust		

	coef	std err	t	P> t	[0.025	0.975]
const	-1.722e-12	0.846	-2.04e-12	1.000	-1.679	1.679
value_fred_CIU2013000100000I_detrended	2.9108	0.334	8.705	0.000	2.247	3.574

Omnibus:	16.748	Durbin-Watson:	0.103
Prob(Omnibus):	0.000	Jarque-Bera (JB):	4.910
Skew:	-0.158	Prob(JB):	0.0859
Kurtosis:	1.967	Cond. No.	2.53

Notes:

[1] Standard Errors assume that the covariance matrix of the errors is correctly specified.

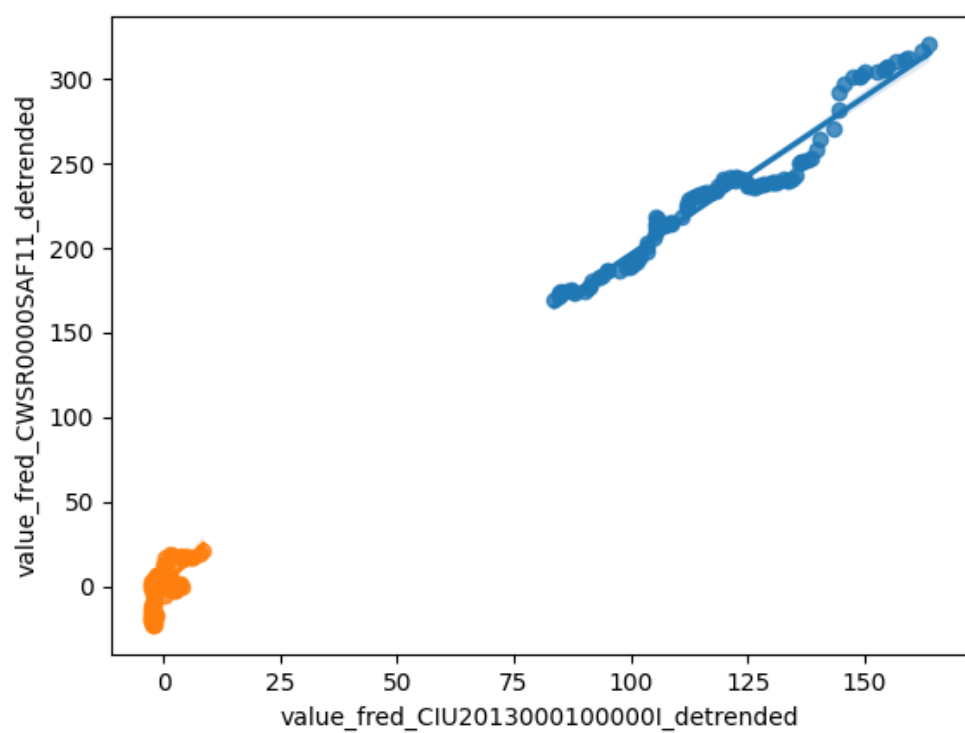


Figure 8: Detrended Regression Plot for 2026-08-27